identification of plants in some herbaria of the world due to the following reasons:

- Description of plants is quite accurate and reliable, because it is mainly based on personal studies from actual specimens and not mere comparisons of known **facts.**
- As it is easy to follow, it is used as a key for the identification of plants in several herbaria of the world.

Though it is a natural system, this system was not intended to be phylogenetic.

5.10.3 Phylogenetic system of classification

The publication of the ***Origin of Species*** (1859) by **Charles Darwin** has given stimulus for the emergence of phylogenetic system of classification.

I Adolph Engler and Karl A Prantl system of classification



Figure 5.7: Adolph Engler and Karl A Prantl

One of the earliest phylogenetic system of classification of the entire plant Kingdom was jointly proposed by two German botanists **Adolph Engler** (1844 -1930) and **Karl A Prantl** (1849 - 1893). They published their classification in a monumental work "***Die Naturelichen Pflanzen Familien***" in 23 volumes (1887-1915)

In this system of classification the plant kingdom was divided into 13 divisions. The first 11 divisions are Thallophytes, twelfth division is **Embryophyta Asiphonogama** (plants with embryos but no pollen tubes; Bryophytes and Pteridophytes) and the thirteenth division is **Embryophyta Siphonogama** (plants with embryos and pollen tubes) which includes seed plants.

II Arthur Cronquist system of classification

Arthur Cronquist (1919 - 1992) an eminent American taxonomist proposed phylogenetic classification of flowering plants based on a wide range of taxonomic characters including anatomical and phytochemical characters of phylogenetic importance. He has presented his classification in 1968 in his book titled "**The evolution and classification of flowering plants**." His classification is broadly based on the Principles of phylogeny that finds acceptance with major contemporary authors.



Figure 5.9: Arthur Cronquist

Cronquist classified the angiosperms into two main classes **Magnoliopsida** (=dicotyledons) and **Liliopsida** (= monocotyledons). There are 6 subclasses, 64 orders, 320 families and about 165,000 species in Magnoliopsida, whereas in Liliopsida there are 5 sub classes, 19 orders, 66 families and about 50,000 species.

Cronquist system of classification also could not persist for a long time because, the system is not very useful for identification and cannot be adopted in herbaria due to its high phylogenetic nature.

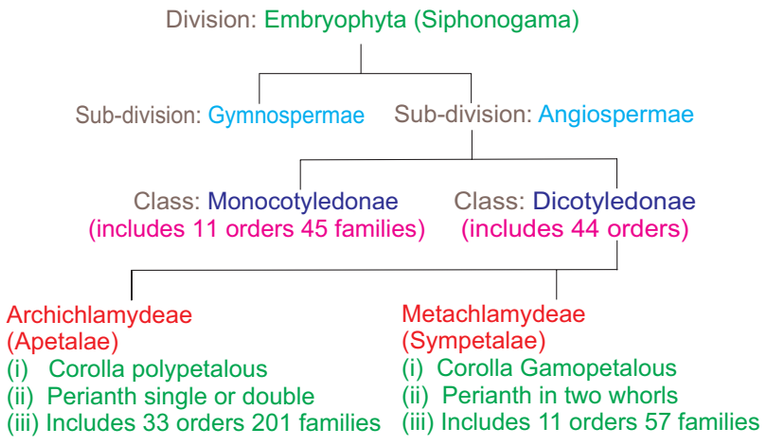


Figure 5.8: Outline of Engler and Prantl classification

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